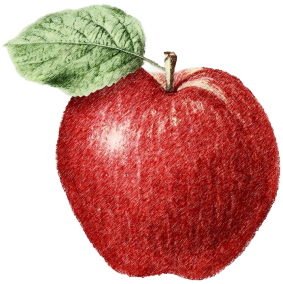
Vanier College

420-541-VA - GAME PROGRAMMING 2 - Section 00001

“See & Threat”

An Apple a Day Keeps the Doctor Away



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Table of Content

1. Game Overview.....3
1.1 Clarity of Concept:.....3
1.2 Target Audience.....3
1.3 Look and Feel.....4
1.4 Game Flow Summary.....4
2. Gameplay and Mechanics.....4
2.1 Core Gameplay Loop.....4
2.2 Progression & Structure.....5
2.3 Rules & Physics.....5
2.4 Interaction Model.....6
3. Story, Setting & Characters.....7
3.1 Depth of Character Profiles.....7
3.2 Relevance to the Story.....8
3.3 Variety & Uniqueness.....9
4. Levels.....9
4.1 Level Progression.....9
4.2 Training Level.....10
4.3 Detailed Structure.....11
4.4 Visual and Spatial Design.....16
5. Interface.....17
5.1 HUD (Heads-Up Display).....17
5.2 Menus & Navigation.....18
5.3 Control Scheme.....18
5.4 Help System.....19
6. Artificial Intelligence.....19
6.1 AI Complexity.....19
6.2 Adaptation & Difficulty.....19
6.3 Non-Combat Behavior.....20
7. Game Art.....20
7.1 Visual Style & References.....20
7.2 Consistency & Theme.....20

1. Game Overview

1.1 **Clarity of Concept**:

- **Game Identity:** A 3D stealth horror adventure where players must navigate a dark, old, abandoned hospital while the dead aid them and the living hunt them.
- **Genre & Style:** Thriller / Escape Room Game with focus on first-person environmental stealth, stamina and resource management, and room-based puzzle-solving.
- **Standout Features**
    - Moving Enemy NPCs: Doctors and nurses follow set patrol paths, chase the player on sight, and attack when in range.
    - Floor Main Challenges: Each floor features a core main task that must be completed before the exit unlocks.
    - Locked Rooms & Micro-Puzzles: Rooms contain interactive puzzles or scattered items required to advance.
    - Heads-Up Display (HUD): Displays current health, active level challenge, and quick-slot inventory.

1.2 **Target Audience**

- Horror & Stealth Fans: Players who seek high-tension environments, inventory management, and tactical evasion over action/combat.
- Puzzle & Escape Room Lovers: Players who enjoy environmental deduction, structural problem-solving, and non-linear exploration.

1.3 **Look and Feel**

- **Art Style & Visuals**
    - Environment: Messy, abandoned hospital with broken equipment, locked doors, and peeling walls.
    - Lighting: High-contrast darkness with deep shadows cut through by bright flashlight beams.
    - Animations: Smooth visual FX and fluid character movement to maintain immersion during movement and stealth.
- **Audio & Sound Design**
    - Ambient Sound: Deep background audio to create constant suspense.
    - Danger Sound: Dynamic panic music that triggers during chases to add urgency and tension.

1.4 **Game Flow Summary**

The game follows a structured, floor-by-floor progression where players start at the hospital's top floor and work their way through increasingly difficult levels going down until the exit.

2. Gameplay and Mechanics

2.1 **Core Gameplay Loop**

The starting point will be the top floor. The game will be divided into multiple floors; each floor can be considered as a level. Each floor will have its own objective and challenge. A floor could look like the following: A player navigates through hallways, rooms, offices and other areas, all while avoiding being eliminated by the evil doctors and nurses. To progress to the next floor, the player must complete the puzzles, gather important items and hide from the doctors and nurses. Finishing a floor will make the next one accessible. As the player progresses, the levels become harder, as the doctor's radar could increase, the puzzle's difficulty could increase, and the available resources might be limited.

2.2 **Progression & Structure**

Level 1 is a tutorial. One nurse patrols the area, and the player learns the basic controls, finds the key and uses the elevator. Difficulty rises with each floor

- Nurses: At first, she walks towards the player with a needle, then as the game progresses she runs at the player, and eventually she will throw the needle/syringe at the player.
- Doctor: His detection radar grows with each level.
- Puzzles: Different on each level, might be longer or harder to do.
- Resources: Oxygen tanks, apples, flashlight batteries become scarcer with the player's progression.

2.3 **Rules & Physics**

Explicit behaviors:

- Health: The player has 3 lives represented as hearts. On each level, if he gets hit by the nurse or doctor, he loses a heart.
- Oxygen: The air is polluted and not safe for the player. He needs to find a tanker; otherwise, he will slowly start losing health.
- Flashlight: It has a usage limit, and when the player uses it, it drains its battery. While in use, it attracts the nurses and doctors, but makes the path clearer for the user.
- Death: If a player loses all three lives, he goes to the previous level and loses his inventory; if he is on level 1, he restarts the level.
- Progression: To access the next floor, the player needs to finish the puzzle and safely reach the elevator.
- Stamina: A player can sprint, but it drains his stamina, and he can’t always be sprinting; the bar restores over time.

Implicit Behaviours

- Stealth and Movement: Sprinting makes the player more vulnerable to detection, while crouching and hiding help them avoid enemies.
- Light and Detection: The flashlight improves visibility, but can attract nearby enemies, forcing the player to balance exploration with stealth.

- Enemy Recovery: When enemies lose sight of the player, they eventually return to their patrol routes, allowing the player to escape and reposition.
- Resource Management: Limited oxygen and flashlight batteries encourage the player to prioritize exploration, collect supplies, and avoid unnecessary delays.
- Ghost Guidance: Friendly ghosts respond to nearby players and provide clues, warnings, and/or resources to help them progress through the hospital floors.
- Environmental Awareness: Changes in lighting, toxic smoke, and audio cues can warn the player of hazards and encourage them to adapt their movement and decisions.

2.4 **Interaction Model**

The game uses a first-person interaction model in which the player interacts with the hospital environment through movement, object interactions, inventory management, and puzzle-solving. The player can explore rooms and corridors, collect useful items, inspect clues, and interact with objects required to progress through each floor.

Players use the interaction key to examine or activate usable objects, such as doors, items, puzzle components, and elevators. Collected items can be equipped and used when needed, while the flashlight helps illuminate dark areas but can also attract nearby enemies.

Interactions take place in real time. This means that enemies can continue moving while the player examines or solves puzzles. This forces the player to remain aware of their surroundings and decide when it is safe to interact with objects.

The player can also interact with friendly ghosts to receive clues, warnings, objectives, and occasionally useful resources. In contrast, dangerous nurses and doctors respond to the player's visibility and actions. The player must use crouching, hiding, and sprinting strategically to avoid detection and escape the pursuit of these harmful and violent enemies.

Progression relies on completing the required puzzles and reaching the staff elevator to descend to the next floor. The interaction model encourages careful exploration, resource management, and quick decision-making under pressure.

3. Story, Setting & Characters

3.1 **Depth of Character Profiles**

Player - Detective

- Backstory: The protagonist of the story is a private investigator and a former detective. He received an anonymous letter containing medical records of missing patients of this hospital. He infiltrated the hospital to expose its secret. But while he was investigating, he was knocked unconscious and locked up on the top floor.
- Personality: Analytical and tenacious
- Appearance: Man in his mid-30s, wearing a trench coat and a fedora hat.
- Abilities:
    - Investigative Vision: Items, clues, and hidden notes will be highlighted.
    - Stealth & Agility: Crouching, hiding, and short sprints.

Nurses and Doctors - Minor Antagonist

- Backstory: Nurses and Doctors were formerly regular healthcare workers, but over time they were corrupted over the years while working under the Director of the hospital. Exposed to many chemical fumes, they became mindless and obedient, maintaining the security of the floors.
- Personality: Mindless and apathetic
- Appearance: Wearing bloodstained uniforms, glowing eyes in the dark.
- Abilities:
    - Fast Runner (Nurses): Nurses will have the ability to chase the player at higher speeds.
    - Wide Vision (Doctors): Doctors have a bigger field of view to cover more of the area.

Director - Main Antagonist

- Backstory: The Director founded the hospital as a front for the public to run experiments on their patients. His goal is to obtain eternal youth and power by performing rituals and experiments on helpless patients.
- Personality: Narcissistic, smart, manipulative and ambitious.
- Appearance: Professional appearance wearing a suit, but has glowing eyes due to mutation.
- Abilities:
    - Psychic: Ability to detect the location of the player during the final level.

Bounded Spirits - Side Character

- Backstory: These tragic souls are former patients of the hospital who have passed due to the experiments of the Director. They are unable to move on due to dark energy, which prevents them from passing on.
- Personality: Sorrowful, helpful and gentle.
- Appearance: Translucent, glowing as figures of patients.
- Abilities:
    - Wayfinder: Points you through key items, safe zones, passageways or provides you with items and clues.

3.2 **Relevance to the Story**

The Detective & The Hospital: The Detective is the catalyst for the narrative. He is brought on this journey with the anonymous letter that brought him there. His goal from the top floor to the ground floor mirrors the hospital's darkest secrets. As he explores through the building, he uncovers more of the truth and secrets of this mystery that he came to investigate.

Relationships:

- The Director: He is the master mind of the building. He runs the facility and stages all of the human experiments for his goal of eternal youth. He monitors the hospital and actively uses his psychic abilities to hunt down intruders.
- Nurses and Doctors: The corrupted staff serve under the director and are mindless and are under his control.

- Bounded Spirits: The spirits are the narrative anchor. They represent the greed of the Director. The spirits have a bond with the Director; they aid with items and clues to ensure that he escapes to bring the Director the justice and set their souls free.

3.3 **Variety & Uniqueness**

Character	Role Type
Player (Detective)	Protagonist
Nurses	Minor Antagonist
Doctors	Minor Antagonist
The Director	Main Antagonist
Bounded Spirits	Side Character / Ally

4. Levels

4.1 **Level Progression**

The game progresses from the top floor of the hospital (Floor 5) down to the ground floor (Floor 1), with each level representing a descent into increasingly hostile and degraded environments. Narratively, the player descends deeper into the hospital's dark history, guided by ghosts who reveal fragments of the story. The final level culminates in a high-stakes escape. Difficulty scales through:

- Environmental Deterioration: Oxygen supply decreases, lighting worsens, and toxic hazards (gas, smoke, pollution) become more prevalent.
- Enemy Escalation: The number, speed, and detection capabilities of enemies increase. New enemy types (Doctors, the Director) are introduced.
- Puzzle Complexity: Puzzles evolve from simple word games to multi-step logic and environmental challenges.

- Resource Scarcity: While oxygen tanks, apples, and batteries remain available, their placement becomes more dangerous and their quantities more limited relative to the threats.

4.2 **Training Level**

The first level, which is the highest floor, will serve as the tutorial and introductory level. On this level, the player will need to bypass one nurse who will be walking in a regular path. This will allow the player to examine her movement and realize she walks in the same route. If the player is in her line of sight, then she will deviate to chase after them with a needle, but if she loses the player, she goes back to her main route.

The main objective will be relatively simple:

- Walk normally
- Run when needed (e.g., when being chased)
- Use their flashlight when needed (e.g., in areas with no light source or dim lighting)
- Equip items (e.g., apples for health regeneration or extended lives)
- Crouch to get through tight spaces
- Hide (e.g., behind sectioned-off curtains)

To make sure the player doesn't feel lost or overwhelmed, they will be introduced to a helpful ghost who will give the player some context and insight on what they need to do next (e.g. needing to first find the key to access the employee room) and who to avoid bumping into (e.g. the only nurse on that floor).

To complete this floor, the player must:

1. Find the key to access the "Employees Only" section of the floor.
2. In that section, find clues on where to locate the keycard for the employee elevator.
3. Use the keycard to unlock the employee elevator and descend to the next floor.

4.3 **Detailed Structure**

Level Breakdown: Floors 5 through 1: The progression of the game moves from top to bottom, meaning that Floor 5 = Level 1 (first level) and Floor 1 = Level 5 (last level). Each floor degrades in atmosphere visibility and oxygen supply while enemy mechanics scale up.

Level 1: Floor 5 (Tutorial Level)

- Environment/Theme: Abandoned old patient hospital floor.
- Objectives:
    1. Primary Goal: Locate the Staff Elevator keycard to reach Level 2
    2. Sub-Objective 1: Reach the "Employees Only" office section.
    3. Sub-Objective 2: Solve the puzzle to get the keycard for the elevator
- Critical Path:
    - Start: Player wakes up in a hospital patient room and meets the Friendly Ghost, who introduces basic rules for how to escape the hospital.
    - Phase 1: Stealth around the patrolling nurse in the hallway to find the computer terminal for solving the puzzle and the "Employees Only" elevator to exit.
    - Phase 2: Locate the computer terminal and complete the puzzle
    - Phase 3: Find and grab the pop-up keycard that gives access to the "Employees Only" Elevator after solving the puzzle
    - Exit: Insert the found keycard into the Staff Elevator panel and ride down to Level 2.
- Key Encounters:
    - 1 Nurse (Walking): Standard, slow patrol loop. Deviation on line-of-sight. This teaches the player to hide behind a curtain or furniture when the nurse is in line of sight in an area.
    - Friendly Ghost: Guide/help the player to a safe spot.
- Puzzle #1: Solve a crossword puzzle
- Resource Distribution:
    - Oxygen Tanks: 2
    - Apples: 2
    - Flashlight Batteries: Unlimited initial charge

Level 2: Floor 4

- Environment/Theme: Deemed old hospital hallway and lobby.
- Objectives:
    1. Primary Goal: Locate the Staff Elevator keycard to reach Level 3
    2. Sub-Objective: Avoid getting caught by hospital staff (nurses, doctors)
- Critical Path
    - Start: Player exits the elevator into a power-deprived lobby (4th floor).
    - Phase 1: Discretely walk around the hallway/lobby and avoid Hospital staff to find clues for the code (locating light numbers scattered around walls and furniture using the flashlight) for the puzzle.
    - Phase 2: Locate the computer terminal to insert the found code.
    - Phase 3: Grab the pop-up Elevator keycard for the next level
    - End: Insert the keycard into the Staff Elevator panel and ride down to Level 3.
- Key Encounters:
    - 3 Nurses with wider patrol loops.
- Puzzle #2: Find Code Mini-Puzzle
- Resource Distribution:
    - Oxygen Tanks: 2
    - Apples: 3
    - Flashlight Batteries: Unlimited initial charge

Level 3: Floor 3

- Environment/Theme: Abandoned Dark Surgical Operation Wing & Operating Hallways with gas linked (green smoke) & red lightning.
- Objectives:
    1. Primary Goal: Locate Staff Elevator keycard to reach Level 4
    2. Sub-Objective 1: Shuff off the gas leak to clear the path to the Operating Room
    3. Sub-Objective 2: Retrieve keycard from the Operating Room
- Critical Path
    - Start: Player exits the elevator into a smoke-filled hallway. The Operating Room where the keycard is, is blocked by thick green gas.
    - Phase 1: Find the maintenance room while avoiding staff. A ghost NPC (a former surgeon) tells the player the gas has to be shut off at the source and provides them with an oxygen tank.
    - Phase 2: Solve Puzzle #3 in the maintenance room to stop the leak. The smoke clears from the Operating Room hallway.
    - Phase 3: Sneak into the Operating Room and take the keycard from the surgical tray.
    - End: Insert the keycard into the Staff Elevator panel and ride down to Level 4.
- Key Encounters:
    - 2 Nurses (Sprinting): Chase the player at high speeds once alerted.
    - 1 Doctor (Expanded Radar): Radar detection radius extended; patrols near the maintenance room. This is the first doctor in the game.
- Puzzle #3: Turn the valves in the maintenance room in a specific order. The hint will be displayed on a whiteboard in the hallway. A wrong valve releases a burst of toxic gas (player loses oxygen), and the valves reset.
- Resource Distribution:
    - Oxygen Tanks: 2
    - Apples: 2
    - Flashlight Batterie: 2

Level 4: Floor 2

- Environment/Theme: Abandoned semi-dark outpatient clinic & waiting room/hallway, with toxic polluted air area
- Objectives:
    1. Primary Goal: Locate Staff Elevator keycard to reach Level 5
    2. Sub-Objective 1: Find the correct patient file in the Records Room
    3. Sub-Objective 2: Cross the heavily polluted zone to reach the exam room.
- Critical Path
    - Start: The player exits the elevator into the waiting room. A broken “Now Serving” display flickers above the reception desk. A ghost (a former patient) sitting in the waiting room says their file holds the way out, and describes themselves (name, room, reason for visit).
    - Phase 1: Sneak through the clinic hallway past the nurses to reach the Records Room.
    - Phase 2: Solve Puzzle #4 to find the ghost's file, which lists an exam room number and a locker code.
    - Phase 3: Cross the polluted zone to reach the exam room.
    - End: Open the exam room locker, take the keycard, and ride the Staff Elevator down to Level 5.
- Key Encounters:
    - 3 Nurses (Sprinting): Chase the player at high speeds once alerted.
    - 2 Doctors (Expanded Radar): Radar detection radius extended; patrols near the maintenance room.
- Puzzle #4: Google Dinosaur-style mini puzzle with a finish line.
- Resource Distribution:
    - Oxygen Tanks: 4
    - Apples: 3
    - Flashlight Batteries: 2

Level 5: Floor 1

- Environment/Theme: Main hospital entrance + reception + grand lobby, near-total darkness lit only by strobing red emergency alarms and moonlight bleeding through boarded-up skylights. Dense, toxic smoke choking the floor (oxygen level= 0)
- Objectives:
    1. Primary Goal: Escape the hospital through the main entrance.
    2. Sub-Objective 1: Collect 3 fuses scattered around the floor.
    3. Sub-Objective 2: Restore power to the main entrance doors
- Critical Path
    - Start: The elevator opens into the dark lobby. The main doors are sealed because the power is cut. The last ghost warns the player about the Director who guards this floor.
    - Phase 1: Find 3 fuses in the reception area, the security office and the gift shop while avoiding the Director. Oxygen drains constantly, so the player can't hide forever,
    - Phase 2: Solve Puzzle #5 at the breaker panel in the security office.
    - Phase 3: Restoring power triggers the alarm. The Director is alerted and hunts the player, leading to a final chase to the main doors.
    - End: Escape through the main entrance. Victory screen.
- Key Encounters:
    - The Director: Uses psychic abilities to hunt intruders, patrolling calmly until power is restored, then entering a relentless, wall-sensing chase that forces the player into a final sprint to the exit.
    - Nurses/Receptionisms: Chase the player at high speed once alerted.
    - Friendly Ghost: Provides final warning.
- Puzzle #5: Pop the Lock inspired puzzle
- Resource Distribution:
    - Oxygen Tanks: 3
    - Apples: 2
    - Flashlight Batteries: 3

Player Health & Inventory Systems (Summary)

Apples restore health. The oxygen meter slowly decreases over time; oxygen tanks replenish it.

Tools & Inventory:

- Flashlight: Battery drains over time and attracts villains.
- Keycard: Earned from puzzles; used to access the Staff Elevator.
- Apples: Heals the player.
- Inventory Reset: Inventory resets to zero if the player dies.
- Flashlight Battery: Resets to full at the start of each new level.

4.4 **Visual and Spatial Design**

The hospital will be designed as an interconnected environment in which main corridors serve as the primary routes between patient rooms, medical offices, storage areas, and treatment rooms. Each floor will have a central navigation route with secondary corridors and side rooms that encourage exploration while creating new opportunities for stealth encounters.

Some rooms will contain essential resources, clues, and/or puzzle elements required to progress to the next floor. Others will provide hiding places or alternative paths that allow the player to move and avoid hostile doctors and nurses. Certain doors and passages will be initially locked, which thus requires the player to explore the floor and complete objectives before being able to access them.

The employee restricted elevators will serve as the main connection between floors and the player's primary means of descending through the hospital. Each floor will require the player to complete a main objective before unlocking the elevator. As the player progresses, environmental layouts will become more complex, with darker corridors, blocked routes, and interconnected rooms that increase tension and navigation difficulty.

The layout will balance linear progression with optional exploration. Although the player needs to ultimately reach the elevator, multiple routes and shortcuts will allow them to make decisions about how to navigate the environment, manage resources, and avoid enemies.

5. Interface

5.1 **HUD (Heads-Up Display)**

- **Health (top-left):** Three heart icons. A heart cracks and fades when the player is hit. The screen flashes red briefly on damage.
- **Oxygen meter (top-left, under the heart):** A blue bar that slowly depletes. It turns red and pulses when low, and the heartbeat audio gets louder. Picking up an oxygen tank refills it.
- **Stamina meter** (**top-left, under the Oxygen meter**): A green bar that drains when a player sprints and slowly restores when he stops sprinting.
- **Current objective (top right):** Short text describing the floor's main challenge and the active objective. It updates as goals are completed (e.g. "Find computer" -> "Solve the puzzle" -> "Use keyboard on the Elevator")
- **Inventory (bottom right):** Showing usable items (apples, oxygen tanks, keycard, flashlight). The equipped item is highlighted and used with the Left Mouse Button. Use the Mouse Scroll Wheel to shuffle between the item slots.
- **Interaction prompt (center):** Appears when looking at something interactable (e.g. "[E] Open door", "[E] Talk", "[E] Pick up apple")
- **Detection indicator (top center):** An eye icon that appears when an enemy notices the player. It's white when an enemy is suspicious and red when the player has been spotted and is being chased. Since the player can't fight back, this is their main warning to hide and run.

5.2 **Menus & Navigation**

- **Start Menu:** New Game, Continue, Controls, Settings, Quit
- **Pause Menu (Esc):** Freezes gameplay. Options are Resume, Restart Level, Controls, Settings
- **Settings:** Music and SFX volume, mouse sensitivity, and brightness
- **Puzzle screens:** Interacting with a computer opens a semi-full-screen puzzle interface (crossword, code entry, etc). Esc exits back to the game. The world keeps running, so solving a puzzle while a nurse patrols nearby is a risk.
- **Game Over screen:** Appears when the player loses all three hearts. It shows an appropriate death message with the options Retry (sends the player back to the previous level without their inventory) and Main Menu.
- **Level transition:** The elevator ride down is a short loading screen showing the new floor number.
- **Victory screen:** Appears when the player escapes through the Floor 1 exit.

5.3 **Control Scheme**

Input	Action	Description
Mouse	Look	Move the first-person camera
WASD	Movement	Move the player around
Shift	Sprint	Run faster for a limited time based on stamina
Ctrl	Crouch	Fit into small spaces, move quietly, stay hidden behind cover
E	Interact	Doors, items, puzzles, hiding spots, and ghost NPCs
Left Mouse Button	Use Item	Use the equipped item
Mouse Scroll Wheel	Switch Item	Cycle through the items in the inventory to choose which one is equipped
Esc	Menu/Pause	Open the pause menu

5.4 **Help System**

- **Tutorial level (Floor 5):** The friendly ghost introduces the rules and goal. The single nurse with a predictable patrol route lets the player practice hiding and sneaking in a low pressure setting.
- **First-time prompts:** The first time the player encounters each mechanic, a short UI tip appears (e.g. “Press Ctrl to crouch behind cover”, “Hold Shift to sprint, energy is limited by stamina”). Tips don’t repeat after that.
- **Objective tracker:** The HUD always shows what the player needs to do next, so they’re never completely stuck.
- **Ghosts NPCs:** Ghosts on later floors can be revisited for hints on the current puzzle or the direction to the elevator.

6. Artificial Intelligence

6.1 **AI Complexity**

Enemies (nurses and doctors): Patrol the corridors in a fixed route between two points, pausing briefly at some of them. When the player gets into an enemy’s field of vision, or sees a flashlight beam, it will be alerted and will face the source. If the source of suspicion gets closer, it will start chasing. If not, it goes back to patrolling.

6.2 **Adaptation & Difficulty**

- Level 1 - Floor 5: 1 Nurse who walks slowly on a short, predictable loop.
- Level 2 - Floor 4: 3 Nurses with wider patrol loops
- Level 3 - Floor 3: 2 Nurses + 1 Doctor - Nurses run during chases, and Doctor’s detection radius is introduced.
- Level 4 - Floor 2: 3 Nurses + 1 Doctor - Nurses throw syringes as a dodgeable ranged attack; the Doctor has a larger detection radius and scans the waiting areas.

- Level 5 - Floor 1: The Director + Nurses/Receptionists - The Director patrols the lobby until the power is restored. Once the breaker panel is fixed, the alarm triggers and he chases the player to the exit without returning to patrol. The receptionist nurses guard the reception area and chase the player once alerted.

6.3 **Non-Combat Behavior**

Friendly NPCs (ghosts): They float near a fixed location (e.g. a patient room or a safe corner) and will face the player when they approach. Pressing on "E" will open a dialogue that gives context, explains the floor's goal, or warns about enemies. Some ghosts can give the player an apple or oxygen tank. In the tutorial, the ghost leads the player to a safe hiding spot to demonstrate how hiding works.

7. Game Art

7.1 **Visual Style & References**

The visual style of the game will be stylized realism. This will be done by combining realistic 3D hospital environments with exaggerated lighting, atmospheric shadows, and subtle supernatural effects. The hospital will feature decaying walls, cracked tiles, rusted medical equipment, flickering fluorescent lights, and abandoned patient rooms. The overall atmosphere will be dark, oppressive, and claustrophobic.

7.2 **Consistency & Theme**

All visual elements will follow a consistent horror/thriller aesthetic using a desaturated colour palette of cold greys, blues, dirty beiges and dark red. The hostile doctors and nurses will have recognizable medical uniforms with threatening silhouettes, while the friendly ghosts will use translucent forms and pale cyan and beige lighting to distinguish them from the living enemies. Also, the antagonists will have colour palettes that are more on the cooler side, similar to the hospital environment, to show their hostility and how they're not friendly and more distant

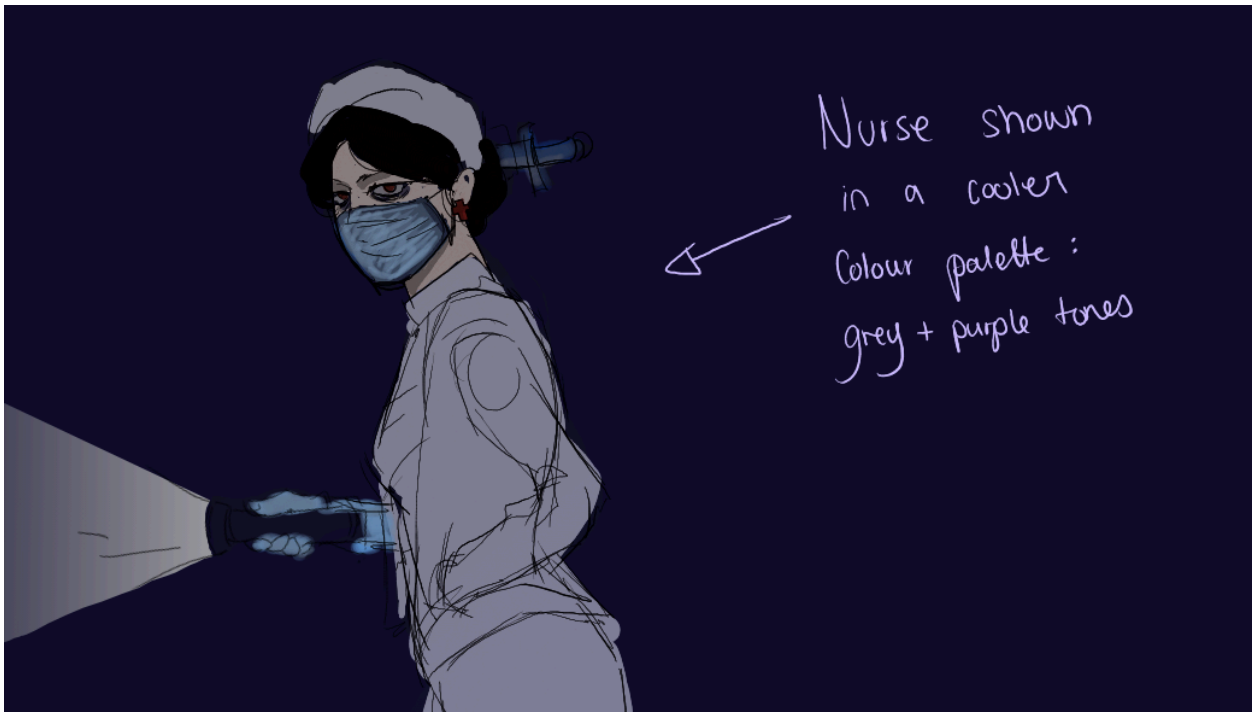
to the player. On the other side, the ally ghosts will be composed of a more warmer colour palette, e.g. they'll have a warm beige / yellow-ish aura. Environmental decay and lighting will intensify as the player descends through the hospital, reinforcing the increasing difficulty and danger. This distinction in colour palettes is also relevant to the rest of the game, for example, the elevators will be seen in warmer tones to showcase progress, safety and hope. Anything that the player needs to survive and complete the levels will also be portrayed in warmer tones (e.g. apples, oxygen tanks, items). The hospital itself will be composed of cooler tones to show how distant and cold it feels.

7.3 **Inspirational References**



Colour Tones - Warm: In this concept art example, the ghost is portrayed using light cyan and warm beige tones to convey a welcoming and reassuring presence. A soft, pastel yellow aura surrounds the ghost, making it easier for the player to identify in the hospital's dark environment. These brighter, warmer colours distinguish the ghost from hostile characters and communicate its role as a friendly entity that assists the player throughout their escape. Also, the apple is portrayed using vibrant shades of warm red, complemented with a bright, yellowish aura. The bright colours create a strong contrast against the hospital's dark muted environment,

making it easier for the player to spot. The warm glow draws the player's attention towards the item, emphasizing its importance as a usable resource that may aid them in their escape.



Colour Tones - Cool: In the concept art example, the nurse is portrayed using muted shades of grey, blue, and purple to convey emotional distance / detachment, hostility and unease. These cool, desaturated colours allow the nurse to blend into the hospital's dark, decaying environment, which makes it harder for the player to distinguish the threat from their surroundings. This reinforces the oppressive atmosphere of the hospital, where the player is trapped and constantly vulnerable to danger.



Game Environment Inspiration: The images above serve as reference points for our hospital setting. Main parts include the rundown equipment, decaying walls and ceilings, and an uneasy feeling.